

Yanai Klugman

Forward Deployed Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Forward deployed software engineer at Kardome for automotive Voice AI customer programs with Hyundai, Toyota, and Renault. Field work across six international customer sites covering discovery, on-site release, vehicle validation, customer-hardware tuning, and demo control software. Native English speaker, Hebrew fluent, Israeli security clearance. M.A. in Organizational Behavior supports customer interviews, executive conversations, and coordination with engineering teams.

EXPERIENCE

Audio Systems & Software Engineer | Kardome

Dec 2024 - Present Tel Aviv, IL

Automotive Voice AI | Forward Deployment

- Validated and shipped Kardome's on-device Voice AI for the 2026 Hyundai ELEXIO customer program with Hyundai's China R&D center (HMTCC), covering QA, field testing, library tuning on customer hardware, and release follow-up.
- Performed vehicle validation across Seoul, Yantai, Sydney, and Dubai, documenting capture quality, wake-up behavior, and in-cabin edge cases for Hyundai customer engineers.
- Integrated Kardome's Voice AI on-site at Toyota R&D in Sunnyvale alongside Toyota's engineering team.
- Implemented offline tool-calling logic that maps free-form driver utterances to OEM vehicle functions and parameters without fixed commands or grammar.
- Configured demo vehicles in Paris and ran Renault engineering evaluations with on-site QA and R&D debugging.
- Deployed Docker Swarm and Traefik runtime controls for offline STT workloads on non-Kubernetes hardware, including wake-up, traffic-swap, and reset thresholds.
- Built an on-site field-engineering utility outside assigned scope for audio tuning, embedded head-unit file management, recording workflows, and demo controls.
- Extended the Python wrapper with recording, channel separation, and microphone-array controls, reducing validation script boilerplate by 95%.
- Prepared demo vehicles for CES 2026 in Las Vegas.

Backend .NET Engineer | BDR Group

May 2024 - Nov 2024 Ness Tziona, IL

Embedded Linux & .NET Backend

- Modernized operator quality-control reporting services during a .NET 8 migration.
- Wired dependency injection and updated CI/CD pipelines for backend service builds.
- Connected embedded Linux devices to production reporting workflows for operator-facing fault tracking.
- Integrated computer-vision model outputs into quality-control reports so line faults surfaced in operator tools.

Solutions & ETL Engineer | Cognyte: NEXYTE

Jun 2023 - Mar 2024 Herzliya, IL

Decision Intelligence Platform

- Adapted NEXYTE's ingestion pipeline to customer-specific data schemas without modifying core product and reused the deployment path across distinct customer environments.
- Obtained Israeli security clearance required for access to sensitive intelligence deployment environments.
- Debugged pipeline and indexing failures across Python transforms, NiFi flows, Kafka topics, and Elasticsearch mappings.
- Mapped phone, location, financial, corporate, and automotive records into Elasticsearch for investigative search.
- Developed Python pipeline components with NiFi, Kafka, and Spark for NEXYTE deployment workflows.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Field & Customer Engineering: On-Site Deployment, Customer Environment Debugging, Requirements Clarification, Technical Demos, Release Follow-Up, Customer Feedback to Product

Systems & Integration: Linux, Embedded Linux, API Integration, Integration Testing, Customer Hardware Debugging, On-Prem Deployment, Edge Deployment, Production Debugging

Software: Python, C++, C, .NET, Bash, PowerShell, CMake, C/C++ Bindings, nanobind

Cloud & Runtime: Docker, Kubernetes, Docker Swarm, Traefik, GitHub Actions, Terraform, AWS, GCP

AI & Data: Tool Calling, LLM Workflow Integration, RAG, OpenAI API, llama.cpp, Elasticsearch, Kafka, NiFi, Spark

Customer Discovery & Communication: Customer Interviews, Requirements Translation, Executive Communication, Technical Writing, Engineering-Team Handoffs, Working With Technical and Non-Technical Teams

TECHNICAL TRAINING

Software Architecture | DevOps Experts 2025 Ramat Gan, IL

- Designed service boundaries and integration points across a three-stage capstone with changing requirements.
- Worked through event-driven, layered, and microkernel architectures, Domain-Driven Design, and serverless patterns on AWS.

DevOps Professional | Technion - Israel Institute of Technology 2024 Tel Aviv, IL

- Built CI/CD pipelines and reproducible cloud deployments with Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, Ansible, Jenkins, and AWS.
- Configured production web servers and reverse proxies with Nginx and Apache.

Computer Science & C/C++ Development | Infinity Labs R&D 2022 - 2023 Ramat Gan, IL

- Completed a selective 32-week full-time C/C++ systems program structured like an R&D team, with project briefs and engineer-led code reviews.
- Built C/C++ projects across memory management, data structures, algorithms, multithreading with pthreads, and TCP/UDP sockets, debugging with GDB and Valgrind.
- Joined Cognyte's NEXYTE engineering team after the program.

PROJECTS

WinWS Slim ISO Builder | Developer Current

- Built an interactive PowerShell/WPF GUI for producing debloated Windows 11 developer workstation installers.
- Published a hosted PowerShell bootstrapper at wwss.yanai.sh for launching the interactive installer.

EDUCATION

M.A. Organizational Behavior & Development | Reichman University 2019 - 2021 Herzliya, IL

- Completed a Siemens Digital Industries Software practicum on post-acquisition integration, interviewing startup leaders and managers about engineering-team handoffs and coordination.
- Invited to serve as teaching assistant for the M&A course after graduation.

B.A. Business Administration & Philosophy | Muhlenberg College 2011 - 2015 Pennsylvania, US

MILITARY SERVICE

Combat Medic, Ta'agad | Combat Engineering Corps, IDF 2016 - 2018

LANGUAGES

English Native (US) | Hebrew Fluent